



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: It's my first time in Italy!



Learning Outcome

Understand actions, events, and experiences in present, past or future and in spoken or written texts and in work and social contexts.

Ask your partner:

- When was the first time you went away from home?
- Where did you go and how did you feel?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about relationships and character traits.
- I can make appropriate pauses between thought groups.
- I can say and use words that are spelled the same but are pronounced differently and have a different meaning.





Let's Explore!

Entranced, he **scanned*** the area.

* When you "scan" an area, you look all around carefully.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

Todd stepped off the airport bus in front of the entrance to the central train station in Milan. Entranced, he scanned the area. Italy! Everything was amazing! He had four hours. What could he do until it was time to board the 3:00 p.m. train to Florence? There wasn't enough time to roam the streets and it was a little too long to be waiting around in the train station. It was Todd's first time in Europe and the first time he had ever left the U.S. Every minute some minute thing caught his eye. The buildings were only a few stories high and more elaborate, and the people looked and walked differently. Todd couldn't stop staring at the people.

Everyone looked so chic and posh like in novels and stories. Even the sounds were novel: the musical tone of the Italian language, the shouting, the honking as motorbikes zoomed in and out of traffic. Todd felt as if he were in another universe. What a change from home! He got out his Student Guidebook to Italy to read what it had to say about Milan. The Stazione Centrale square, he read, is full of pickpockets. Be especially careful not to walk around reading your guidebook, so no one will suspect you are a tourist and easy prey. Todd slowly gazed around. Everyone suddenly looked like a suspect to him.

He thought, "I'll close the guidebook and go to a cafe close by." When Todd approached the cafe, he realized that getting food might be a little difficult since he didn't know any Italian. The friendly vendor brought out a selection of panini on a tray and Todd chose one. When the vendor said 'Coffee?' Todd nodded, smiling. The waiter returned with an espresso that smelled heavenly. Todd handed him some euros. He had started to relax.

Todd noticed that there were a lot of other young people milling around the station. They were from everywhere it seemed by their accents. Todd was really amazed at how small the world, which he had thought was so big, really was.





Let's Practice!

Todd talks about his experience at the train station.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences below and circle the mistakes you find. Correct the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. What could he do until it were time to board the 3:00 p.m. train to Florence?
2. There wasn't enough time to roam the streets and it was a little too long to be waited around in the train station.
3. It was Todd's first time in Europe and the first time he had ever leaves the U.S.
4. The buildings were only a few stories high and more elaborate, and the people looking and walked differently.
5. Even the sounds was novel the musical tones of the Italian language, the shouting, and the honking as motorbikes zoomed in and out of traffic.
6. Be especially careful not to walk around reading your guidebook, so no one will suspected you are a tourist and easy prey.



Let's Practice!

Todd talks about his first European trip.

Instructions: Read the sentences. Fill in the gaps with the phrases from the Word Bank. There are extra options you do not need to use.

Word Bank

since he didn't know any Italian / felt as if he / couldn't stop staring / friendly vendor / he knew Italian well / friendless winder / suddenly looked suspect

1. Todd _____ at the people.
2. Todd _____ were in another universe.
3. Everyone _____ to him.
4. He realized that getting food might be a little difficult _____.
5. The _____ brought out a selection of panini.





Extension Activity

Watch a video about a famous city in Europe.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Go online or to the library and watch and listen to a video on a famous city in Europe in English.
- While you are watching, take note of the sights and sounds and places that you see.
- Watch again and listen to the descriptions of the places shown and take down some of the adjectives and phrases used to describe the places.
- Use your notes to tell a partner what you have seen.
- Be careful to use appropriate pauses between thought groups.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I watch and listen to a video on a famous city in Europe in English.

☐ ☐

I take notes of the sights and sounds and places that I see.

☐ ☐

I listen to the descriptions of the places shown and take down descriptive adjectives and phrases.

☐ ☐

I use my notes to tell a partner what I have seen.

☐ ☐

I am careful to use appropriate pauses between thought groups.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- to entrance** (verb): to be focused with wonder and delight
e.g. Entranced, he scanned the area.
- to roam** (verb): to walk or travel without any real purpose or direction
e.g. There wasn't enough time to roam the streets.
- to honk** (verb): to emit a loud, short noise
e.g. Even the sounds were novel – the musical tones of the Italian language, the shouting, and the honking as motorbikes zoomed in and out of traffic.
- tone** (noun): sound
e.g. Even the sounds were novel, especially the musical tones of the Italian language.
- pickpocket** (noun): one who steals things out of pockets or bags
e.g. The Stazione Centrale square, he read, is full of pickpockets.
- selection** (noun): the variety of things from which to choose
e.g. The friendly vendor brought out a selection of panini on a tray and Todd chose one.
- panini** (noun): a small, flat loaf of Italian bread that is often cut, filled with cheese, meat, or vegetables, and eaten warm
e.g. The friendly vendor brought out a selection of panini on a tray and Todd chose one.
- heavenly** (adjective): giving great pleasure
e.g. The waiter returned with an espresso that smelled heavenly.
- to mill** (verb): to move around
e.g. Todd noticed there were a lot of other young people milling around the station.





Learning Points

Using Pauses (Intonation in Non-Final Thought Groups)

A key strategy in being understood by others when you speak English is pausing between groups of words in your sentences. That means that you do not need to speak continuously - you pause for a very brief time between groups of words.

There are two reasons that you should pause when speaking:

1. It gives the listener time to process your speech.

When you take a short pause between thoughts when you are speaking, you give the person who is listening time to consider what you have said.

For example:

Why would you take time off now and not when everybody else has a vacation?

Why would you take time off now // and not when everybody else // has a vacation?

The second sentence is easier to understand since there are very brief pauses between each thought group.

1. It allows you to emphasize one or more main words in a sentence.

Pausing also helps the listener understand what has been said. When you speak, you put emphasis on the final content word in a group. This final stressed content word is also said with a higher pitch.

For example:

*Why would you take time off **now** // and not when everybody **else** // has a **vacation**?*

When you speak, you put emphasis on the final content words (nouns, verbs, adjectives, adverbs) in thought group (now, else, vacation).

Try reading these sentences from the text. Make sure you pause appropriately.

Examples:

- What could he **do** // until it was time to board the 3:00 p.m **train** // to Florence?
- There wasn't enough time to roam the **streets** // and it was a little too **long** // to be waiting around in the train station.
- It was Todd's first time in **Europe** // and the first time he had ever left the U.S.
- The buildings were only a few stories **high** // and more **elaborate**, // and the people **looked** // and walked differently.
- Even the sounds were **novel** // the musical tones of the Italian **language**, // the **shouting**, // and the **honking** // as motorbikes zoomed in and out of traffic.
- Be especially careful not to walk around reading your **guidebook**, // so no one will suspect you are a **tourist** // and easy prey.





Learning Points

Homographs

Homographs are words with different pronunciation and meanings but the same spelling. When you need to know how to pronounce homographs, you need to understand the context of the word. Then you can figure out the meaning of the word, and therefore know how to say the word correctly.

Here is a list of homographs. Notice that the spelling is the same but the meaning and pronunciation are different.

bass – (bAss) type of fish OR (bays) low, deep voice
 bow – (boe) type of knot OR (bauw) to incline
 entrance – (entrins) the way in OR (entrans) to delight
 evening – (evuh -ning) smoothing out OR (evening) after sunset
 learned – (learnd) past tense of learn OR (learnid) knowledgeable
 minute – (maynute) tiny OR (minute) unit of time
 row – (roe) line/ propel a boat OR (rauw) argument
 wound – (wownd) past tense of wind OR (woond) to injure

Take a look at these examples from the text. Say the words out loud.

Examples:

- Todd stepped off the airport bus in front of the **entrance** to the central train station in Milan. **Entranced**, he scanned the area.
- Every **minute** some **minute** thing caught his eyes.
- The buildings were only a few **stories** high and more elaborate, the people looked and walked differently.
- Even the sounds were **novel** – the musical tones of the Italian language, the shouting, and the honking as motorbikes zoomed in and out of traffic.
- What a change from home!
- He got out his Student Guidebook to Italy to **read** what it had to say about Milan.
- Be especially careful not to walk around reading your guidebook, so no one will **suspect** you are a tourist and easy prey.
- Everyone suddenly looked **suspect** to him.
- He thought, "I'll **close** the guidebook and go to a cafe **close** by."

